

College Students and TikTok: Factors that Drive College Students on Brand Choices while Using Social Media

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Introduction

This study aims to explore the factors influencing college students' adoption of TikTok and provide insights into their social media usage behaviors. As a result, the following research will address the research question: What factors influence college students' use of TikTok? Based on this specific research question, this research will attempt to develop a deeper understanding of why TikTok has become a dominant platform among this demographic.

The study paper will collect background information about TikTok, its competitors, and the broader landscape of social media platforms through industry reports. Then, a literature review will be conducted to examine preliminary studies on social media adoption and engagement behaviors among college students. The literature search will help identify possible predictors of college students' TikTok usage, such as social influence, entertainment needs, habitual use, and information-seeking behaviors. Once the proposed predictors are determined, we will conduct research using a survey to generate insights and recommendations on the key drivers of TikTok engagement among college students.

The Client

TikTok, developed by the Chinese technology company ByteDance, is a short-form video-sharing platform that has experienced rapid global growth since its international launch in 2018 (Congressional Research Service, 2023). Originally introduced as Douyin in China in 2016, the platform allows users to create, share, and discover short videos set to music, comedy sketches, and various other genres. According to the Congressional Research Service (2023), "TikTok's parent company ByteDance continues to expand the app's presence globally, despite ongoing scrutiny from regulators regarding its data privacy policies" (p. 4).

As of 2024, TikTok's user base is predominantly young adults, with 56% of U.S. adults aged 18 to 34 reporting that they use the platform (Pew Research Center, 2024). This indicates that over half of TikTok's U.S. adult users are within the college-age demographic. Furthermore, studies suggest that "TikTok's unique algorithm-driven content personalization is a major factor in attracting and retaining users in this age group" (Zhang, 2022, p. 12).

TikTok's success is largely attributed to its advanced recommendation algorithm, which identifies user preferences to provide personalized content recommendations (Zhang, 2022). Research highlights that "TikTok's algorithm dynamically adapts to user behavior, making content discovery seamless and highly engaging" (Zhang, 2022, p. 15). This capability allows the platform to evolve continuously, catering not only to a collective audience but also to individual users' tastes (Zhang, 2022).

Despite its rapid growth, TikTok has faced scrutiny over data privacy and security concerns, particularly due to its Chinese ownership (Congressional Research Service, 2023). The

Congressional Research Service (2023) reports that “concerns regarding data storage, foreign influence, and misinformation on TikTok have led to regulatory debates and potential restrictions in various countries” (p. 6). Such concerns have prompted ongoing discussions about potential bans and legislative action against the platform in regions like the U.S. and Europe (Congressional Research Service, 2023).

In summary, TikTok has established itself as a dominant force in the social media landscape, particularly among young adults, through its innovative content delivery, engaging user experience, and advanced algorithm-driven personalization (Pew Research Center, 2024; Zhang, 2022).

The Clients, The Competition, The Industry

The Competition

Global Short-Form Video Competitors

TikTok’s primary competition comes from other major social media platforms that have integrated short-form video content, particularly Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts. As social media consumption trends evolve, both platforms have actively adapted to challenge TikTok’s market dominance (Smith, 2024). Research indicates that “Meta Platforms and YouTube would be the largest beneficiaries of a pending TikTok ban” (Smith, 2024, para. 2), showcasing their aggressive expansion into short-video content.

Instagram Reels, launched in 2020, is directly embedded within Instagram and leverages its existing user base to promote short videos (Meta, 2023). Unlike TikTok, which relies on an algorithm-driven discovery model, Instagram Reels prioritizes content from followed users and

influencers (Cai, Qin, & Yang, 2023). Meanwhile, YouTube Shorts, introduced in 2021, benefits from YouTube's long-form video ecosystem and offers creators monetization incentives to migrate their content from TikTok (Liu, 2022).

Fast-Growing Competitors

Apart from Meta and YouTube, TikTok also faces competition from other video-sharing platforms catering to younger audiences. Snapchat remains a key competitor, offering Spotlight, a TikTok-style short-form video section launched in 2020 (Snap Inc., 2023). Research suggests that Snapchat's "disappearing content model and emphasis on privacy make it a preferred choice for Gen Z users" (Yao, Zhong, & Jiang, 2023, p. 56).

Additionally, Likee, a Singapore-based short-video platform, has gained traction in Southeast Asia and the Middle East, markets where TikTok is still expanding (Kumar, 2023). With AR effects, music integration, and localized content strategies, Likee has positioned itself as a regional leader (Zhao, 2022).

Emerging Competitors in Restricted Markets

Due to regulatory scrutiny and potential bans in countries like India and the United States, new platforms have emerged to fill the void left by TikTok. In India, the ban on TikTok in 2020 led to the rise of Chingari, Moj, and Josh, which now dominate the short-video market (Sharma & Gupta, 2023). According to a study, "homegrown alternatives have captured over 40% of India's short-video market, previously controlled by TikTok" (Sharma & Gupta, 2023, p. 121).

Similarly, in the United States, potential legislation targeting TikTok's data privacy policies has opened opportunities for Clash and Triller, U.S.-based platforms focusing on creator monetization and decentralized content discovery (Liu, 2022). While these platforms have yet to surpass TikTok's engagement levels, they benefit from growing concerns over data security in Western markets (Congressional Research Service, 2023).

In conc

In conclusion, TikTok operates in a highly competitive environment, facing direct threats from Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts, fast-growing competitors like Snapchat and Likee, and emerging platforms in regions where TikTok faces restrictions. However, its AI-driven recommendation system, strong user engagement, and continuous innovation continue to position it as the leader in short-form video content (Yao et al., 2023).

The Industry

The short-form video industry has experienced significant growth in recent years, driven by technological advancements, changing consumer preferences, and increased smartphone

usage. Platforms such as TikTok, Instagram Reels, and YouTube Shorts have become central to this trend, attracting substantial user bases and advertising investments.

In 2024, the global short-form video market was valued at approximately $34.79 billion and is projected to reach $289.52 billion by 2032, reflecting a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 30.33% over the forecast period (Business Research Insights, 2024). This rapid expansion underscores the increasing importance of short-form video content in the digital media landscape.

Key Industry Trends

1. **Algorithm-Driven Content and Personalization**

   Short-form video platforms heavily rely on artificial intelligence (AI) algorithms to deliver personalized content to users. Research indicates that AI-driven content curation has significantly increased user engagement and retention on platforms like TikTok (Zeng & Kaye, 2022). TikTok's "For You Page" (FYP) algorithm is a leading example of how machine learning is used to continuously refine content recommendations based on user preferences.

2. **Monetization and E-Commerce Integration**

Monetization strategies within the short-form video sector have evolved beyond traditional advertising to include direct e-commerce integrations. Platforms are increasingly enabling in-app shopping experiences, allowing users to purchase products featured in videos seamlessly. This convergence of entertainment and commerce has opened new revenue streams and enhanced user engagement (Vogue Business, 2024).

3. Regulatory Challenges and Market Dynamics

The industry faces significant regulatory scrutiny, particularly concerning data privacy and content moderation. For example, potential bans on TikTok in markets like the United States have prompted users and advertisers to explore alternative platforms such as Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts. These developments highlight the dynamic nature of the industry and the need for platforms to navigate complex regulatory environments (Financial Times, 2025).

The short video industry is characterized by rapid growth, intense competition and constant innovation. Platforms are expanding ways to monetize and adapt to the regulatory environment while competing for user attention and market share. Keeping ahead of these trends is critical for stakeholders looking to capitalize on the opportunities in this dynamic industry.

Literature review

The rapid rise of TikTok has significantly impacted social media engagement, particularly among college students. Understanding the factors that influence brand choices within this demographic requires an examination of various theoretical frameworks and constructs. To study the social media usage based on college students, the concepts, theories, models, and predictors discussed in social media from different points of views.

Entertainment and Content Appeal

One of the strongest factors influencing students' preference for TikTok over other social media platforms is its highly engaging and entertaining content format. Unlike text-based or static image platforms like Facebook and Instagram, TikTok's short-form video format caters to shorter attention spans and maximizes user engagement (Whiting & Williams, 2013). Research suggests that entertainment gratification is one of the most significant motivations for social media use among younger demographics, and platforms that offer more visually engaging content tend to dominate in popularity (Sundar & Limperos, 2013). Studies indicate that TikTok's ability to deliver endless personalized content based on user preferences through AI-driven algorithms makes it more addictive compared to traditional platforms (Xu & Liu, 2023). The platform's "For You Page" (FYP) continuously curates content that matches users' interests, keeping them engaged for longer periods than scrolling through static posts on Instagram or Facebook (Salasac & Lobo, 2022). This aligns with prior research suggesting that users prefer platforms that offer highly interactive and engaging content that reduces cognitive effort while maximizing entertainment value (Guo, 2021).

Social Interaction and Peer Influence

Another major factor in TikTok's popularity among college students is its strong social engagement and peer-driven interactions. Unlike traditional social networks that rely on follower-based content exposure, TikTok's algorithm-driven visibility allows users to interact with a broader audience, creating a more dynamic and socially engaging experience (Guo, 2021). Research on social media influence suggests that peer validation and social proof are critical in determining platform choice, as individuals tend to follow the platforms where their friends and influencers are most active (Whiting & Williams, 2013). Moreover, TikTok's collaborative

features, such as duets, stitches, and viral challenges, encourage user participation, making social engagement more immersive than passive scrolling on Instagram or Snapchat (Xu & Liu, 2023). Studies indicate that college students are more likely to choose platforms that allow greater peer interaction and user-generated content participation, further reinforcing TikTok's dominance in this age group (Salasac & Lobo, 2022).

Information-Seeking and Trend Discovery

Beyond entertainment and social engagement, information-seeking has become an essential factor in social media platform selection. While platforms like Twitter and Facebook have traditionally been associated with news and information dissemination, TikTok has emerged as an alternative source for discovering trends, product recommendations, and real-time discussions (Xu & Liu, 2023). Prior research has shown that college students use TikTok to discover fashion trends, viral news, and consumer reviews, often relying on influencer content for product validation (Guo, 2021). Compared to Instagram, where content is more curated, TikTok's algorithmic recommendation system ensures that users receive immediate, relevant information tailored to their interests (Salasac & Lobo, 2022). This aligns with studies that highlight social media's growing role in real-time information dissemination and trend forecasting (Whiting & Williams, 2013).

Habit Formation and User Maintenance

A critical element that differentiates TikTok from other social media platforms is its ability to create habitual usage behaviors. Research on social media habits indicates that platforms that encourage frequent, repeated interactions through personalized recommendations

and gamified engagement mechanisms are more likely to retain users (Venkatesh et al., 2012). TikTok's infinite scroll and algorithm-driven engagement model make it particularly habit-forming compared to other social media platforms (Xu & Liu, 2023). Studies suggest that college students tend to develop strong platform loyalty when social media use becomes an integrated part of their daily routines, particularly when content consumption requires minimal effort and offers continuous rewards (Guo, 2021). In contrast, Facebook and Instagram content discovery mechanisms rely more on user-initiated searches, making them less likely to foster habitual engagement (Salasac & Lobo, 2022). This helps explain why TikTok has become the preferred social media platform for many young users.

Theoretical framework

Social media usage theories and models

Theory of Planned Behavior(TPB), Uses and Gratification theory (UGT), The Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology 2 (UTAUT2) are the most common theories used in social media usage studies.

Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)

The Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB), developed by Ajzen (1991), is a widely recognized framework for predicting human behavior in various contexts, including social media usage. TPB points out that an individual's behavioral intentions are shaped by three key constructs: attitude toward the behavior, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control. This theory has been applied to understand why individuals engage with social media platforms

like TikTok, Facebook, and Instagram. Attitude refers to an individual's overall evaluation of the behavior—whether they perceive it as favorable or unfavorable (Ajzen, 1991). Research has shown that a positive attitude towards social media significantly influences the intention to use it. Subjective norms refer to the perceived social pressure to engage in a behavior (Ajzen, 1991). In the context of social media, this means how much influence friends, family, and society have on an individual's decision to use platforms like TikTok or Instagram. Perceived behavioral control (PBC) refers to an individual's perception of their ability to perform a behavior, considering potential facilitators and barriers (Ajzen, 1991).

The Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) provides a strong theoretical foundation for understanding why college students use social media. Attitudes, social norms, and perceived behavioral control are key factors that shape behavioral intentions. Studies suggest that social influence, entertainment value, and ease of access are the primary drivers of social media engagement. Extensions of TPB, such as self-identity and belongingness, further enhance its applicability to social media adoption.

Proposed Predictors

Social Interaction
(Whiting & Williams, 2013)

Information Seeking
(Whiting & Williams, 2013)

Entertainment
(Whiting & Williams, 2013)

Self-Expression and Identity Formation
(Whiting & Williams, 2013)

Convenience and Accessibility
(Whiting & Williams, 2013)

Social Needs
(Katz,Blumler, & Gurevitch, 1973).

Information-Seeking Needs
(Chen & Kim, 2013; Quan-Haase & Young, 2010).

Narcissistic Needs
(Buffardi & Campbell, 2008).

Escape Needs
(Katz, Blumler, & Gurevitch, 1973).

Hedonic Motivation
(Venkatesh et al., 2012).

Habitual Use
(Venkatesh st al.,2012).

Social Influence
(Venkatesh st al.,2003).

Content Algorithm Personalization

(Yao et al., 2023)

Ease of Use

(Venkatesh et al., 2003)

Short-Form Video Engagement
(Liu, 2022)

Perceived Trendiness

(Guo, 2021)

Platform Loyalty

(Venkatesh et al.,2012)

Monetization Motivation
(Meng & Leung, 2021)

FOMO (Fear of Missing Out)
(Guo, 2021)

Communicatory Utility
(Why People Use Social Media, 2021)

Surveillance and Social Knowledge
(Why People Use Social Media, 2021)

Instant Gratification
(Sundar & Limperos, 2013)

Creative Self-Expression
(Kearney, 2018)

Selected Proposed Predictors

1. **Background Factors**
- Digital Media Exposure -BF1
- Access to Mobile Devices -BF2

2. **Behavioral Beliefs About TikTok**
- Perceived Entertainment Value -BB1
- Perceived Personalization of Content -BB2
- Short-Form Video Engagement -BB3

3. **Normative Beliefs About TikTok**
- Peer Influence -NB1
- Fear of Missing Out (FOMO) -NB2

4. **Control Beliefs About TikTok**
- Habitual Use -CB1
- Monetization Motivation -CB2

5. **Attitude Toward TikTok**
- Creative Self-Expression -ATT1
- Emotional Attachment -ATT2

6. **Subject Norms About TikTok**
- Social Validation -SN1
- Surveillance and Social Knowledge SN2

7. **Perceived Behavioral Control Over TikTok Usage**
- Perceived Self-Control Over Usage -PBC1

1. Background Factors

Constructions: Digital Media Exposure -BF1

Definition: Digital media exposure refers to the extent to which individuals interact with various forms of digital content, including social networking platforms, video streaming services, online news, and other digital information sources. The degree of exposure influences how individuals consume and engage with digital media and their level of dependence on digital platforms (Venkatesh et al., 2012).

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time.					

I rely on digital media as my primary source of news and information.					
I feel disconnected when I cannot access digital media for a prolonged period.					
Most of my social interactions take place through digital media rather than face-to-face communication.					

Constructions:Access to Mobile Devices -BF2

Definition: Access to mobile devices refers to the availability and usability of mobile technology, including smartphones and internet connectivity, which enable individuals to engage with digital platforms. The accessibility of mobile devices plays a critical role in shaping individuals' digital behaviors and consumption habits (Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Measurements	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**
I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use.					
I have reliable internet access on my mobile device at most times.					
I use my mobile device for various purposes beyond communication, such as entertainment,					

shopping, and work.					
It would be difficult for me to go a full day without using my mobile device.					

2. **Behavioral Beliefs About TikTok**

Constructions: Perceived Entertainment Value -BB1

Definition: Perceived entertainment value refers to the fun, pleasure, and enjoyment derived from using TikTok. It plays a significant role in influencing technology acceptance and user engagement, particularly in hedonic information systems (**Venkatesh et al., 2012**)

Measurements	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**
Watching TikTok videos is fun and enjoyable.					
TikTok helps me pass time when I'm bored.					
I prefer TikTok over other social media for entertainment.					
The content on TikTok keeps me engaged for long periods.					

Construction: Perceived Personalization of Content -BB2

Definition: Perceived personalization of content refers to the extent to which TikTok's algorithm customizes and tailors content recommendations to align with a user's preferences and behaviors, enhancing user engagement and satisfaction (Liu, 2022).

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
TikTok's recommendations match my interests.					
The platform provides content that feels customized to me.					
The more I use TikTok, the better its suggestions become.					
I rarely need to search for content because TikTok shows me what I like.					

Construction: Short-Form Video Engagement -BB3

Definition: Short-form video engagement refers to the degree to which users interact with and prefer brief, high-consumption video formats on platforms such as TikTok. It includes behaviors such as frequent video watching, participation in trends, and content sharing (Zhong, 2023).

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
I prefer watching short-form videos over longer ones.					
Short videos on TikTok are more engaging than traditional content.					
I frequently watch multiple short videos in one sitting.					

Short videos provide the information and entertainment I need quickly.					

3. **Normative Beliefs About TikTok**

Construction: Peer Influence -NB1

Definition: “Heavy users of TikTok can use the technology as a means to meet new friends, keep in contact with people they have no or little time to meet in person, and feel involved with what’s going on with their friends.” (Meng & Leung, 2021)

Measurements	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**
Measure My friends influence my decision to use TikTok.					
I started using TikTok because of peer recommendations.					
My peers share TikTok content that I engage with.					
Seeing others use TikTok makes me more likely to use it too.					

Construction: Fear of Missing Out (FOMO) -NB2

Definition: The psychological drive that compels users to frequently check TikTok to avoid missing out on new content, trends, or social updates (Guo, 2021)

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
I might miss something important if I don’t check TikTok.					
I feel left out when my friends talk about TikTok trends that I haven't seen.					
I use TikTok more frequently when I see others engaging with it.					
I often check TikTok to stay updated with trends.					

4.Control Beliefs About TikTok

Construction: Habitual Use -CB1

Definition:“Habitual behaviors, getting a glimpse of what others are doing, receiving recognition from others, and seeking news/information…” (Chen & Kim, 2013; Quan-Haase & Young, 2010)

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
I use TikTok daily without actively					

deciding to do so.					
I often find myself scrolling on TikTok without planning to.					
I feel uncomfortable if I don't check TikTok regularly.					
Checking TikTok has become part of my daily routine.					

Construction: Monetization Motivation -CB2

Definition: The motivation to use TikTok as a platform for monetary gains, such as influencer marketing, brand partnerships, and live streaming (Meng & Leung, 2021).

Measurements	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**
I use TikTok to earn money. Monetization features on TikTok make the platform more appealing to me.					
I believe TikTok offers good opportunities for financial gain.					
Monetization features on TikTok make the platform more appealing to me.					
I create content on TikTok with financial benefits in mind.					

5. Attitude Toward TikTok

Construction: Creative Self-Expression -ATT1

Definition: The extent to which users leverage TikTok's video editing tools and music features to express themselves creatively (Kearney, 2018).

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
TikTok allows me to express myself.					
I use TikTok to showcase my talents and interests.					
TikTok provides tools that help me create unique content.					
Posting on TikTok is an important form of self-expression for me.					

Construction: Emotional Attachment -ATT2

Definition: Emotional attachment refers to an individual's affective bond with a technology, reflecting their enjoyment, liking, and personal connection to the platform. It encompasses feelings of pleasure, satisfaction, and habitual association with the technology (Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree

TikTok is an important part of my daily life.					
I would feel a loss if I could no longer use TikTok.					
TikTok brings me positive emotions and enjoyment.					
I feel connected to TikTok's community.					

6. Subject Norms About TikTok

Construction: Social Validation (SN1)

Definition: Social validation refers to the psychological need for approval and reinforcement through engagement metrics such as likes, shares, and comments on TikTok. This construct emphasizes the influence of social presence and peer validation on user behavior, driving content creation and platform engagement (Zhong, 2023).

Measurements	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**
I feel good when my TikTok videos receive more likes.					
Engagement on TikTok makes me feel more accepted.					

I often check how many views and comments my posts get.					
TikTok interactions boost my confidence.					

Construction: Surveillance and Social Knowledge (SN2)

Definition: Surveillance and social knowledge refer to the extent to which users rely on TikTok to stay informed about trends, social events, and popular culture. It reflects the role of TikTok as a news and trend-monitoring tool, where users actively engage with content to remain socially aware and connected (Liu, 2022).

Measurements	**Strongly Disagree**	**Disagree**	**Neutral**	**Agree**	**Strongly Agree**
I use TikTok to keep up with trending topics.					
TikTok helps me with cultural and social events.					
I rely on TikTok for news and updates on various topics					
TikTok keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circles.					

7. Perceived Behavioral Control Over TikTok Usage

Construction: Perceived Self-Control Over Usage (PBC1)

Definition: Perceived self-control over usage refers to an individual's ability to regulate and manage their time and engagement with a technology. It encompasses perceived behavioral control, self-discipline, and the awareness of excessive usage, reflecting the extent to which users believe they can limit their use of the system if needed (Venkatesh et al., 2003)

Measurements	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
I can easily stop using TikTose TikTok.					
I often exceed the time I planned to spend on TikTok.					
I sometimes feel that TikTok use interferes with my daily responsibilities.					
Even if there is interesting content on TikTok, I can restrain myself from using it frequently.					

Instrument

Q1 Welcome to our survey!

Welcome! You are invited to participate in a research study about why college students prefer TikTok or other social media platforms. This survey is completely anonymous, and it will take

around 10–15 minutes to complete. Your participation is voluntary, and you may stop at any time.

Do you consent to participate in this study?

- Yes, I agree to participate
- No, I do not want to participate

Q2 The first part of the questionnaire is about you

Which short video platform do you use most frequently?

- TikTok
- Instagram Reels
- YouTube
- Facebook

Q3 This part is about cross-platform product-specific experience.

Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above.

Q3	Strongly disagree(1)	Disagree(2)	Neutral (3)	Agree(4)	Strongly agree(5)
I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time.					
Most of my social interactions take place through digital media rather than face-to-face communication.					
I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use.					
Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable.					

This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored.					
This platform's recommendations match my interests.					
The more I use it, the better its suggestions become.					
I prefer watching short-form videos over longer ones.					
I frequently watch multiple short videos in one sitting.					
Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too.					
I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so.					
I often find myself scrolling without planning to.					
I use this platform to keep up with trending topics.					
This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle					
I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it.					
I can easily stop using this platform.					

Q4 This part is about Brand-Specific Experience.

The following questions specifically ask about [] app. Please rate your agreement.

Here "[] app" represents the app you have chosen.

Q4	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
[] is an important part of my daily life.					
I would feel a loss if I could no longer use [].					
[] brings me positive emotions and enjoyment.					
I feel connected to []'s community.					
[] allows me to express myself.					
I use [] to showcase my talents and interests.					
[] provides tools that help me create unique content.					
Posting on [] is an important form of self-expression for me.					
I feel good when my [] videos receive more likes.					
Engagement on [] makes me feel more accepted.					
I often check how many views and comments my posts get.					
[] interactions boost my confidence.					
I might miss something important if I don't check [].					
I feel left out when my friends talk about [] trends that I haven't seen.					
I use [] more frequently when I see others engaging with it.					
I often check [] to stay updated					

with trends.					
I use [] to earn money.					
Monetization features on [] make the platform more appealing to me.					
I believe [] offers good opportunities for financial gain.					
I create content on [] with financial benefits in mind.					

Q11 Demographics

What is your age?

_____

Q12

What is your gender?

- Male
- Female
- Non-binary/third gender
- Prefer not to say

Q13

What year are you in college?

- Freshman
- Sophomore
- Junior
- Senior

- Graduate

Q14

Do you create content on social media?

- Yes
- No

_____End of the survey_____

Methodology

To better understand what factors influence college students' brand choice on social media platforms, this study adopted the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB), as the theoretical framework. Constructs and items were adapted using Elasmar's (2021) Red Flags Approach to ensure clarity, reliability, and construct validity.

A self-administered online questionnaire was created and distributed using Qualtrics. The survey consisted of multiple sections including informed consent, platform preference (e.g., TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, Facebook), general social media habits, and brand- and product-specific attitudes toward the chosen platform. All latent variables were measured using a 5-point Likert scale, ranging from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree).

Data were collected from April 1 to April 10, 2025. A total of 47 valid responses were obtained. To ensure data quality, only surveys with 100% completion were retained. No responses were excluded for incompleteness or inconsistency. Descriptive statistics were conducted using SPSS

to analyze the demographic profile. Of the 47 participants, 55.3% were female ($N = 26$) and 44.7% were male ($N = 21$). In terms of academic status, 91.5% were graduate students ($N = 43$), while the rest were either freshmen (4.3%) or seniors (4.3%).

To ensure response quality, the dataset was screened based on survey completion status and response consistency. All responses had a 100% completion rate, and no participants were excluded due to incomplete or invalid data. Data were analyzed using SPSS. Descriptive statistics were first computed to examine sample characteristics. In the next stage, inferential statistics including t-tests, ANOVAs, Pearson correlations, and multiple linear regressions will be conducted to test the research hypotheses.

The next stage will be to examine the measurements using Elasmar's (2021) 'Red Flag Approach', which involves grouping, initial screening, validity testing, reliability testing, and calculation of true score estimates.

Analysis and Results

To develop and pre-test the measurement instruments for our study, we adopted the Red Flag Approach (Elasmar, 2021) as a structured confirmatory framework. This approach allowed us to systematically assess the quality of our survey items and identify potential weaknesses prior to full-scale data analysis. Through this iterative validation process, we were able to refine the instrument and ensure that each item aligned with the theoretical constructs derived from TPB. By applying the Red Flag Approach, we increased the likelihood that the measurements would yield accurate and meaningful insights into the factors influencing college students' brand choices on social media platforms such as TikTok.

Phase1: Propose Grouping

In the first phase, we grouped the survey items into constructs based on prior theoretical frameworks and validated measurement scales found in the literature. Given that our constructs were adapted directly from existing studies and organized through the lens of TPB, there was no need to create new groupings from scratch. This pre-established structure included constructs such as hedonic motivation, habitual use, peer influence, emotional attachment, and perceived behavioral control. The use of literature-based groupings ensured content alignment and conceptual consistency across items, thus supporting the validity of our measurement model and streamlining subsequent analysis.

Phase2: Initial Screening

The purpose of Phase 2 was to ensure that the measures used in the following analyses were appropriate and free from major data issues. Following Elasmar's Red Flags Approach, four steps were completed: checking frequency distributions, reverse coding where necessary, inner qualitative review, and computation of inter-item correlations.

Step A: Frequency Check

First, the frequency distribution of each item was examined to check for constants, outliers, heavily skewed distributions, and significantly smaller sample sizes. No measures exhibited constant responses . While some items displayed moderate skewness, none were considered heavily skewed to the extent that would require removal. No significantly smaller sample sizes were observed for any items, and thus, all items were retained for further analysis.

Step B: Reverse Coding

After reviewing the wording of the items, no items required reverse coding. All questions were phrased in a consistent, positively oriented direction regarding participants' usage behaviors and motivations on the platform.

Step C: Inner Qualitative Review

A qualitative assessment was conducted to ensure thematic consistency within and between item groupings. According to Elasmar's Red Flags guidelines, items within a construct should:

1. Overlap with the definition of the construct they are intended to measure,

2. Share similar underlying meanings,

3. Maintain logical consistency among possible responses.

Step D: Computation of Inter-Item Correlations

The final step involved analyzing the inter-item correlation matrix for Q3_1 to Q3_16 to detect potential measurement issues.

1. **Within-Group Correlations:**

   Correlations among items within the same proposed groupings were generally moderate to strong, typically ranging from $r = .50$ to $r = .90$, indicating good convergent validity without redundancy.

2. **Red Flag Thresholds:**

Following Elasmar's guidelines:

- Inter-item correlations below .30 suggested that items may not be measuring the same construct.
- Inter-item correlations above .90 suggested redundancy (items being too similar).
- If a correlation between two items across different groups was stronger than correlations within the group, that also raised red flags.

For the measure "Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable" (Q3_5) was found to be weakly correlated with the other measures in the same construct group. Specifically, the inter-item correlation between Q3_5 and the other items was around $r = .20$, which is below the acceptable threshold of .30 suggested in Elasmar's Red Flags guidelines.

This finding is consistent with the qualitative assessment conducted earlier. Although Q3_5 conceptually related to entertainment use, it captures a slightly different dimension of user experience — emphasizing enjoyment rather than habitual usage or multitasking, which were the dominant themes among the other measures. Thus, Q3_5 might not fully overlap with the intended construct domain.

As a result, a red flag was raised for Q3_5, indicating that it may not be capturing the same construct as its intended group. Further attention will be given to Q3_5 in subsequent phases to determine whether it should be retained or removed from the construct.

Phase 3: Testing Groupings for Constructs Validity

The measures were subjected to a principal component factor analysis with varimax rotation. The rotation converged in 5 iterations, and three components were extracted. The

rotated component matrix revealed that while many measures loaded clearly onto one factor, several items exhibited cross-loading issues, raising validity concerns.

Factor Loading #1

The researcher first ran three sets of constructs together, based on the theoretical grouping: Habitual Usage (Q4_1, Q4_2, Q4_3), Emotional Attachment (Q4_4, Q4_5, Q4_6), and Monetization Motivation (Q4_7, Q4_8, Q4_9). According to the rotated component matrix, the first set of questions (Habitual Usage) loaded primarily on Component 1, with strong loadings such as .693 for "I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time" and .895 for "Most of my social interactions take place through digital media rather than face-to-face communication." However, the item "I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time" also showed a secondary loading of .559 on Component 2, indicating cross-loading. This cross-loading raises a red flag because the measure is not purely associated with one factor and might be capturing multiple constructs simultaneously.

Therefore, the item "I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time" may have a validity issue and needs to be carefully considered in subsequent analysis.(Table 1-5).

Factor Loading #2

Within the Emotional Attachment construct, the measure "This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored" had a primary factor loading of .73 on Component 1 but also a substantial secondary loading of .60 on Component 2.

Similarly, "This platform's recommendations match my interests" loaded .55 w on Component 1 and .71 on Component 2. These cross-loadings suggest that the Emotional Attachment construct is not clearly distinguished from other constructs in the grouping. Because two items within the

same theoretical grouping load heavily on two different components, a red flag was raised indicating that these items may be measuring two overlapping but distinct constructs rather than a unified concept of Emotional Attachment.

Thus, the validity of Emotional Attachment as a standalone construct is questionable and adjustments may be needed.(Table 1-5).

Factor Loading #3

Regarding the Monetization Motivation construct, several measures showed severe cross-loadings as well. For example, "I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so" had a factor loading of .76 on Component 1 and .55 on Component 2.

"I often find myself scrolling without planning to" loaded .38 on Component 1 and a very high .87 on Component 2. Additionally, "I use this platform to keep up with trending topics" loaded .61 on Component 1 and .71 on Component 2. The appearance of such strong cross-loadings across these items indicates that they are simultaneously capturing behaviors related to both habitual use and emotional attachment, rather than solely Monetization Motivation.

Because multiple items have high loadings on two components, a serious red flag was raised for this group. Thus, the measures under Monetization Motivation may not reflect a clean, distinct factor and will require either item removal or construct redefinition before proceeding to the next phases. (Table 1-5).

Modification of Measurements						
Before				**After**		
Construct	**Item**		**Modification**	**Construct**	**Item**	
	I often use				I often use	

Q3_1-Q3_4	multiple digital media platforms at the same time. Most of my social interactions take place through digital media rather than face-to-face communicatio n I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use. Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable.		**Construct Merged**	Factor 1	multiple digital media platforms at the same time. Most of my social interactions take place through digital media. I always have access to a smartphone. Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable. This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored.	
Q3_5-Q3_8	This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored. This platform's recommendati ons match my interests. The more I use it, the better its suggestions become. I prefer watching		**Construct Merged**	Factor 2	This platform's recommendation s match my interests. The more I use it, the better its suggestions become. I prefer watching short-form videos over longer ones. I frequently watch multiple	

	short-form videos over longer ones.		**Construct Merged**		short videos in one sitting. Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too. I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so. I often find myself scrolling without planning to.	
Q3_9-Q3_12	I frequently watch multiple short videos in one sitting. Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too. I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so. I often find myself scrolling without planning to.		**Construct Merged**	Factor 3	I use this platform to keep up with trending topics. This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle. I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it. I can easily stop using this platform.	
Q3_13-Q3_16						

I use this platform to keep up with trending topics.

This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle.

I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it.

I can easily stop using this platform.

Phase 4: Test Groupings for Content Validity

A reliability analysis was conducted using a 5-point Likert scale to assess the internal consistency of each construct grouping. Cronbach's alpha values were computed for all constructs. The analysis showed that BF1, BB2, and BB3 achieved 'Excellent' reliability, each with a Cronbach's alpha above .940. CB1 also demonstrated acceptable reliability, with a Cronbach's alpha of .80, categorized as 'Good.' To improve the internal consistency of CB1, one item was removed during the analysis process. In summary, all constructs demonstrated satisfactory levels of internal consistency, confirming that the measurement scales are reliable for further analysis.

Reliability					
Construct	**N**	**Cronbach's Alpha**	**Level of Reliability**	**Number of Items**	**Items Removed**
BF1	48	0.960	Excellent	4	
BB2		0.960	Excellent	4	
BB3		0.943	Excellent	4	
CB1		0.797	Very Good	3	1 item removed

Phase 5:

In Phase 5, only the constructs that had passed validity and reliability assessments were included. Composite scores were computed for each construct by averaging the scores across the individual items that remained after the prior screening phases. This method provides the best available estimate of each individual's standing on the construct.

All constructs demonstrated appropriate score distributions. The means ranged from 3.880 to 4.171, and skewness values were within acceptable limits, indicating no significant skewness issues.

Descriptive Statistics of Final Constructs(Table 15)

Construct	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation	Variance	Skewness	Std. Error
BF1	48	1.00	5.00	3.9115	1.2836	1.648	-1.083	.343
BB2	48	1.25	5.00	4.1719	1.0684	1.141	-1.323	.343
BB3	48	1.00	5.00	4.0781	1.1265	1.269	-1.208	.343
CB1	48	1.25	5.00	3.8802	1.0053	1.011	-0.653	.343

Discussion

This study investigated key factors influencing college students' engagement with TikTok, focusing on background exposure, behavioral beliefs, and control beliefs. Overall, the constructs demonstrated strong internal consistency and conceptual clarity after undergoing validity and reliability checks.

The Background Factors construct (BF1), which measured general digital media exposure and habits, showed excellent reliability. This suggests that students' broader media engagement patterns, such as frequent use of mobile devices and multitasking across platforms, are consistently reported and play a significant role in shaping TikTok usage. Behavioral Beliefs constructs (BB2 and BB3) also achieved excellent reliability, highlighting students' positive perceptions of platform content.

Control Beliefs (CB1) initially showed lower internal consistency compared to other constructs. However, after the removal of one problematic item ("I can easily stop using this platform."), its reliability improved significantly. This adjustment indicates that while most control-related behaviors cluster well together, students may interpret the idea of "easily stopping usage" differently, suggesting the presence of perceived addiction or habitual usage patterns that require further exploration.

Several limitations should be noticed. First, the relatively small sample size (N=48) restricts the generalizability of the findings. Future research should collect data from a larger and more diverse population to improve external validity. Second, the study relied entirely on self-reported data, which could be influenced by recall bias or social desirability bias. Third, while the constructs adapted from prior research were effective, future iterations could benefit from developing more platform-specific measurement items to better capture the unique nuances of TikTok user experiences.

Despite these limitations, the study provides valuable initial insights into how students' digital backgrounds, belief structures, and perceived control influence their engagement with short-form video platforms. The findings suggest that TikTok's success is closely tied to its

ability to match user interests, promote habitual content consumption, and create a highly accessible and engaging user environment.

Future research should not only expand the sample size and refine measurement tools, but also consider longitudinal designs to capture changing patterns of digital media engagement over time. Additionally, a more in-depth investigation of the psychological mechanisms underlying perceptions of control (or lack thereof) of platform use would contribute to a more detailed understanding of college students' social media behaviors.

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Appendix

Table 1

Rotated Component Matrix[a]

	Component 1	Component 2
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time.	.888	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - Most of my social interactions take place through digital media rather than face-to-face communication.	.885	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use.	.907	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable.	.958	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored.	.941	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - This platform's recommendations match my interests.	.874	

Table 2

Rotated Component Matrix[a]

	Component 1	Component 2	Component 3
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time.	.693	.559	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - Most of my social interactions take place through digital media rather than face-to-face communication.	.895	.306	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use.	.851	.390	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. - Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable.	.805	.533	

Table3

Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored.	.733	.594	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform's recommendations match my interests.	.554	.713	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – The more I use it, the better its suggestions become.	.743	.546	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I prefer watching short-form videos over longer ones.	.711	.537	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I frequently watch multiple short videos in one sitting.	.667	.621	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too.	.448	.761	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so.	.757	.549	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often find myself scrolling without planning to.	.375	.869	

Table4

Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform to keep up with trending topics.	.614	.710	
Double-click to activate r the stions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle	.641	.686	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it.	.688	.647	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I can easily stop using this platform.			.980

Extraction Method: Principal Component Analysis.
Rotation Method: Varimax with Kaiser Normalization.

a. Rotation converged in 5 iterations.

Table 5

Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too.	.817	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so.	.927	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often find myself scrolling without planning to.	.836	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform to keep up with trending topics.	.918	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle	.925	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it.	.939	
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I can easily stop using this platform.		.969

Extraction Method: Principal Component Analysis.
Rotation Method: Varimax with Kaiser Normalization.

a. Rotation converged in 3 iterations.

Table 6

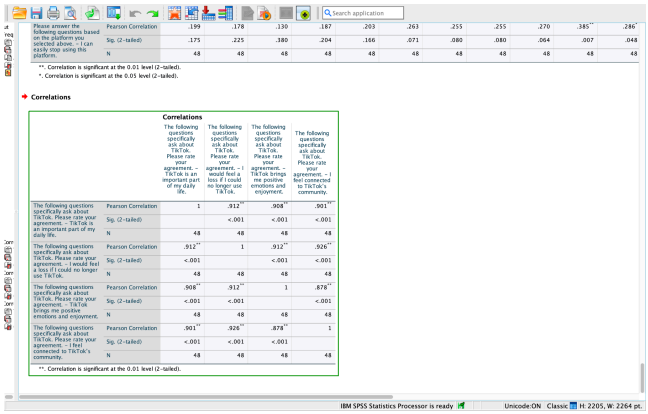
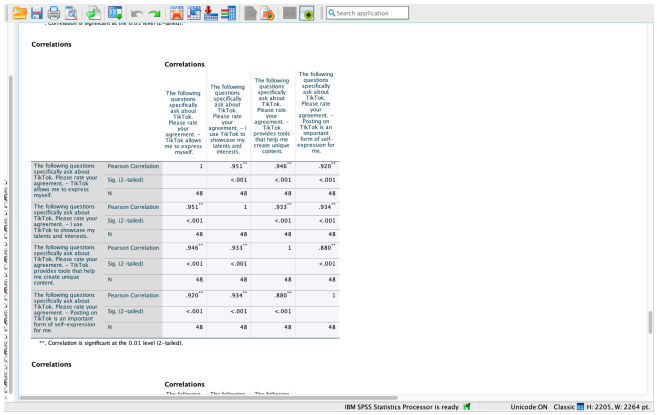


Table 7



Correlations

Correlations

		The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – TikTok allows me to express myself.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I use TikTok to showcase my talents and interests.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – TikTok provides tools that help me create unique content.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – Posting on TikTok is an important form of self-expression for me.
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – TikTok allows me to express myself.	Pearson Correlation	1	.951**	.946**	.920**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I use TikTok to showcase my talents and interests.	Pearson Correlation	.951**	1	.933**	.934**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – TikTok provides tools that help me create unique content.	Pearson Correlation	.946**	.933**	1	.880**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – Posting on TikTok is an important form of self-expression for me.	Pearson Correlation	.920**	.934**	.880**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

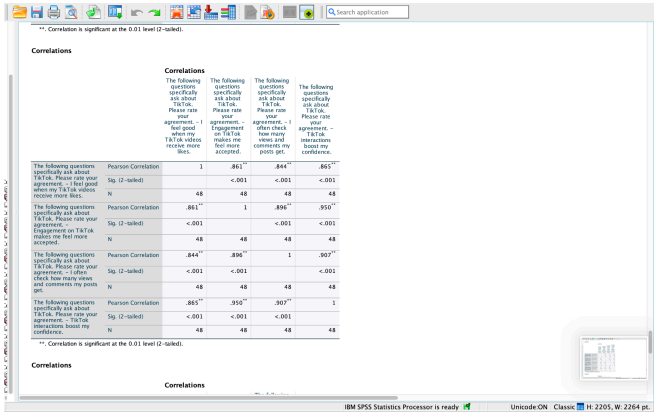
**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

Correlations

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Table 8



**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

Correlations

		The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I feel good when my TikTok videos receive more likes.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – Engagement on TikTok makes me feel more accepted.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I often check how many views and comments my posts get.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – TikTok interactions boost my confidence.
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I feel good when my TikTok videos receive more likes.	Pearson Correlation	1	.861**	.844**	.865**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – Engagement on TikTok makes me feel more accepted.	Pearson Correlation	.861**	1	.896**	.950**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I often check how many views and comments my posts get.	Pearson Correlation	.844**	.896**	1	.907**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – TikTok interactions boost my confidence.	Pearson Correlation	.865**	.950**	.907**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

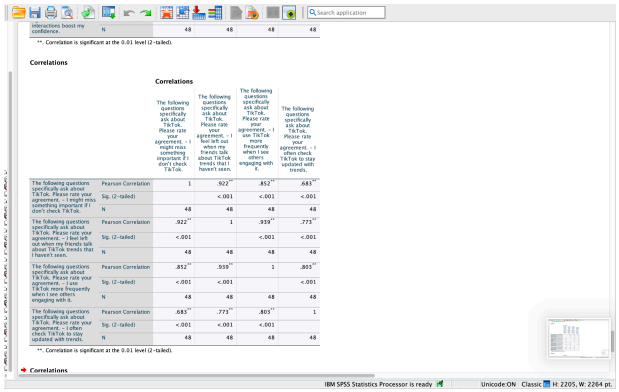
**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

Correlations

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Table 9



interactions boost my confidence.	N	48	48	48	48

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

Correlations

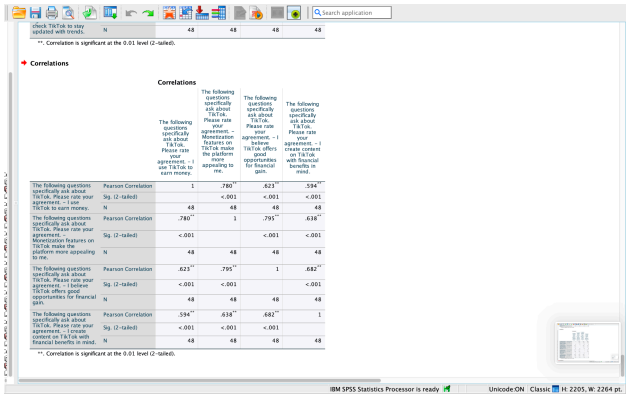
		The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I might miss something important if I don't check TikTok.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I feel good when my friends talk about TikTok trends that I haven't seen.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I use TikTok more frequently when I see others engaging with it.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I often check TikTok to stay updated with trends.
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I might miss something important if I don't check TikTok.	Pearson Correlation	1	.922**	.852**	.683**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I feel good when my friends talk about TikTok trends that I haven't seen.	Pearson Correlation	.922**	1	.939**	.773**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I use TikTok more frequently when I see others engaging with it.	Pearson Correlation	.852**	.939**	1	.803**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I often check TikTok to stay updated with trends.	Pearson Correlation	.683**	.773**	.803**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

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Table 10



Correlations

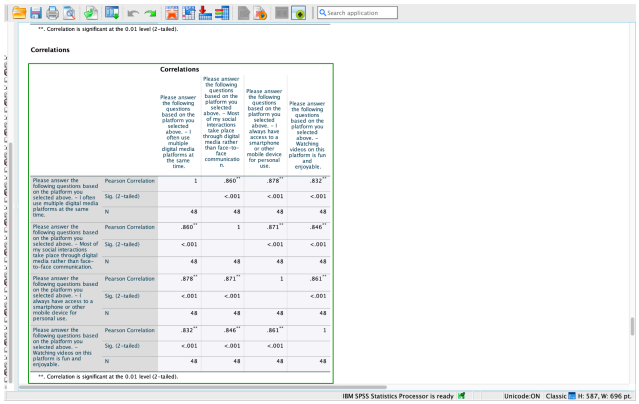
		The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I use TikTok to earn money.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – Monetization features on TikTok make the platform more appealing to me.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I believe TikTok offers good opportunities for financial gain.	The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I create content on TikTok with financial benefits in mind.
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I use TikTok to earn money.	Pearson Correlation	1	.780**	.623**	.594**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – Monetization features on TikTok make the platform more appealing to me.	Pearson Correlation	.780**	1	.795**	.638**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I believe TikTok offers good opportunities for financial gain.	Pearson Correlation	.623**	.795**	1	.682**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
The following questions specifically ask about TikTok. Please rate your agreement. – I create content on TikTok with financial benefits in mind.	Pearson Correlation	.594**	.638**	.682**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

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Table 11



Correlations

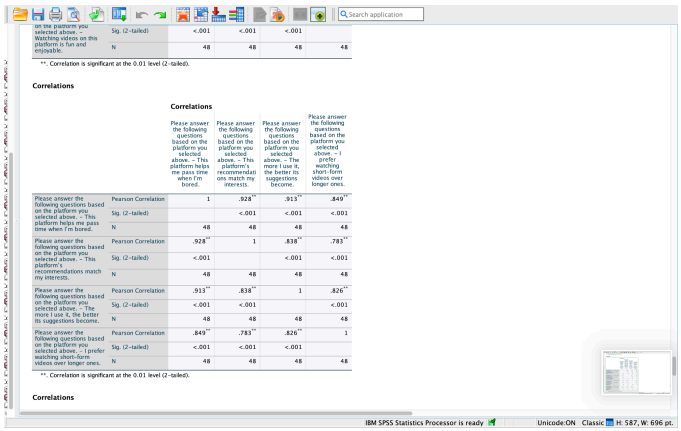
		Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Most of my social interactions happen through digital media rather than face-to-face communications.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable.
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often use multiple digital media platforms at the same time.	Pearson Correlation	1	.860**	.878**	.832**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Most of my social interactions happen through digital media rather than face-to-face communications.	Pearson Correlation	.860**	1	.871**	.846**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I always have access to a smartphone or other mobile device for personal use.	Pearson Correlation	.878**	.871**	1	.861**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Watching videos on this platform is fun and enjoyable.	Pearson Correlation	.832**	.846**	.861**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

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Unicode:ON Classic H: 587, W: 696 pt.

Table 12



Correlations

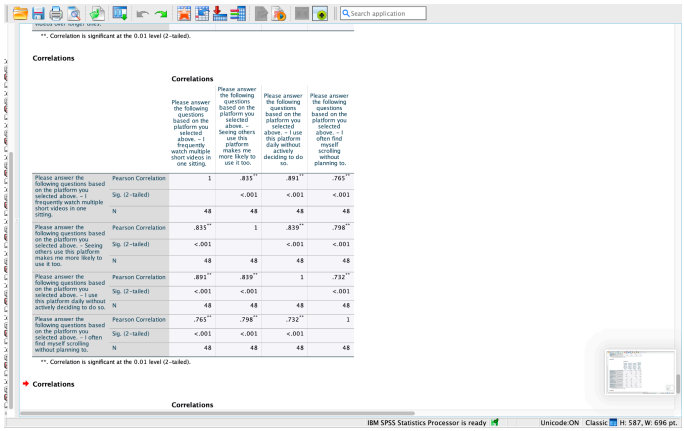
		Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform's recommendations match my interests.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – The more I use it, the better its suggestions become.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I prefer watching short-form videos over longer ones.
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform helps me pass time when I'm bored.	Pearson Correlation	1	.928**	.913**	.849**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform's recommendations match my interests.	Pearson Correlation	.928**	1	.838**	.783**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – The more I use it, the better its suggestions become.	Pearson Correlation	.913**	.838**	1	.826**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I prefer watching short-form videos over longer ones.	Pearson Correlation	.849**	.783**	.826**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

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Unicode:ON Classic H: 587, W: 696 pt.

Table 13



Correlations

Correlations

		Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I frequently watch multiple short videos in one sitting.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often find myself scrolling without planning to.
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I frequently watch multiple short videos in one sitting.	Pearson Correlation	1	.835**	.891**	.765**
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – Seeing others use this platform makes me more likely to use it too.	Pearson Correlation	.835**	1	.839**	.798**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform daily without actively deciding to do so.	Pearson Correlation	.891**	.839**	1	.732**
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		<.001
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often find myself scrolling without planning to.	Pearson Correlation	.765**	.798**	.732**	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001	<.001	
	N	48	48	48	48

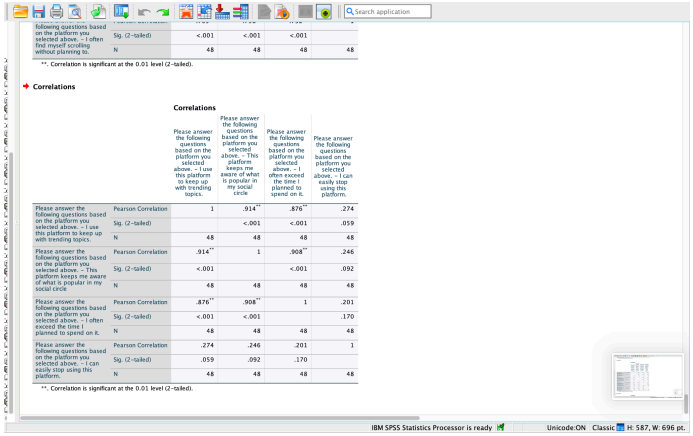
**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

Correlations

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Table 14



		Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform to keep up with trending topics.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it.	Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I can easily stop using this platform.
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I use this platform to keep up with trending topics.	Pearson Correlation	1	.914**	.876**	.274
	Sig. (2-tailed)		<.001	<.001	.059
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – This platform keeps me aware of what is popular in my social circle	Pearson Correlation	.914**	1	.908**	.246
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001		<.001	.092
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I often exceed the time I planned to spend on it.	Pearson Correlation	.876**	.908**	1	.201
	Sig. (2-tailed)	<.001	<.001		.170
	N	48	48	48	48
Please answer the following questions based on the platform you selected above. – I can easily stop using this platform.	Pearson Correlation	.274	.246	.201	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.059	.092	.170	
	N	48	48	48	48

**. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).

Correlations

Correlations

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Table 15

Descriptives

Descriptive Statistics

	N Statistic	Minimum Statistic	Maximum Statistic	Mean Statistic	Std. Deviation Statistic	Variance Statistic	Skewness Statistic	Skewness Std. Error
BF1	48	1.00	5.00	3.9115	1.28358	1.648	-1.083	.343
BB2	48	1.25	5.00	4.1719	1.06835	1.141	-1.323	.343
BB3	48	1.00	5.00	4.0781	1.12651	1.269	-1.208	.343
CB1	48	1.25	5.00	3.8802	1.00529	1.011	-.653	.343
Valid N (listwise)	48							